

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr Iftikhar Ahmed

Address: Bay Cottage 5 Park Road Cheam SM3 8QB

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: Dear Planning Committee Members,

I am writing as a long-standing resident of this community to express my unequivocal and strong support for planning application DM2025/01591, which proposes the establishment of a much-needed community centre within our neighbourhood. I firmly believe this development will deliver significant and tangible benefits, aligning closely with the principles of sustainable communities and local wellbeing promoted by both national and local planning policies, including those outlined by Sutton Council.

The provision of a dedicated community centre is a vital initiative that will profoundly enhance the social infrastructure of our area. I am particularly encouraged by the commitment to creating an inclusive space, with facilities and programmes open to all residents, irrespective of background. This aligns perfectly with the National Planning Policy Framework's (NPPF) emphasis on fostering strong, vibrant, and healthy communities, and Sutton Council's strategic objectives for community cohesion and resident empowerment.

I am especially supportive of the proposed health and wellbeing programmes, including dedicated health clinics and proactive community health initiatives. By delivering preventative healthcare, educational workshops, and wellbeing sessions locally, this centre will significantly improve access to crucial services for individuals and families. This directly contributes to reducing health inequalities and promoting healthier lifestyles, which are key priorities within Sutton Council's Local Plan and its commitment to improving public health outcomes for its residents.

Regarding potential concerns often raised in planning deliberations, particularly around school rush and parking, I wish to provide important context from a local resident's perspective. It is crucial to recognise that the primary users of this proposed community centre will largely comprise existing members of our community, many of whom are already engaging with local facilities, including schools. The parents and carers currently involved in the daily school drop-off and pick-up routines are precisely the individuals who will benefit most from, and utilise, this new facility. Therefore, the centre is not anticipated to generate significant new traffic or parking demand from outside the immediate area, but rather to serve and consolidate existing community activity within a well-designed and accessible local hub. This approach promotes walking, cycling, and short local trips, contributing to Sutton Council's sustainability goals by reducing reliance on private vehicles for essential services.

Having thoroughly reviewed the submitted plans, I am confident that the design is both proportionate and thoughtfully conceived, ensuring harmonious integration with the surrounding area. The scale, appearance, and architectural approach appear entirely in keeping with the established residential character of the neighbourhood. This careful consideration for local context demonstrates adherence to good design principles, a cornerstone of effective planning policy, ensuring the development integrates respectfully without detriment to local amenity.

In conclusion, I believe this proposal represents an outstanding opportunity to create a valuable community asset that will foster social inclusion, improve health outcomes, and enhance the overall quality of life for all residents. It is a development that is demonstrably sensitive to its surroundings while providing significant and lasting community benefit. I respectfully and strongly urge the Planning Committee to approve planning application DM2025/01591, allowing our community to realise the immense potential of this project.

Thank you